centre for pediatric emergencies and specialized care

Plaster Cast Care

How can you keep the cast in good shape?

- **Keep it dry.** Cover the cast with a waterproof bag when bathing
- **Do not rest cast on a hard surface** or corner for first 3 days; cast may take 3 days to completely dry and doing so may dent your cast
- **Keep it clean**. Avoid getting dirt or sand inside the cast
- **Avoid lotions**. Do not place powder, lotion, cream or deodorant on or underneath the cast.
- **Do not insert objects inside the cast**. Do not scratch the skin underneath the cast with an object, as this can damage the skin or the cast
- **Leave cast changes to your doctor.** Do not trim the cast edges or pull the padding out of the cast

What should you expect in the first week?

- You may have **PAIN** for the first week. To control your pain:
    - Use Ibuprofen or Acetaminophen (unless allergic) per instructions on the bottle
    - Keep the broken bone raised, using a sling/pillow, to lower the swelling
- The skin underneath your cast may feel **ITCHY**. This is normal
    - To relieve itchy skin, use a hair dryer (on cool setting) to blow air into the cast

Do you need to see another health care professional?

- Yes, our team will book an appointment for you for re-assessment and/or cast removal at UP
- If a referral to an orthopedic or plastic surgeon was needed, our team will ensure to transmit the referral electronically and inform you of next steps

When should you ask for help?

- Your cast gets wet
- An object has fallen into the cast or the cast is broken
- There is redness on the skin around the cast edges
- Your pain is getting worse or pain medications are not helping
- Your fingers or toes become blue or white

What do I do if have a complication?

- Return to Centre UP at the site closest to your home between 8am-8pm; no appointment needed.
- If notice something at night, unless severe pain or major concern, come first thing in the AM.